



Seaplanes

Air

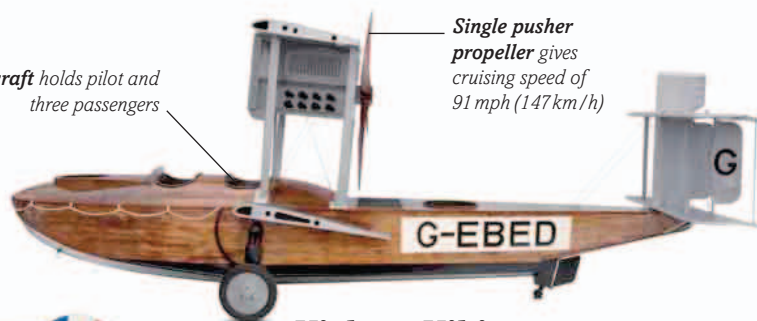


Fabric-covered wing with wooden frame

Sopwith Baby
UK 1915

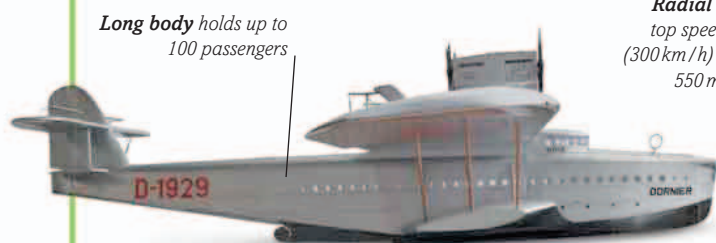
Wooden tail float keeps rear of aircraft out of water

Aircraft holds pilot and three passengers



Single pusher propeller gives cruising speed of 91 mph (147 km/h)

Vickers Viking UK 1919



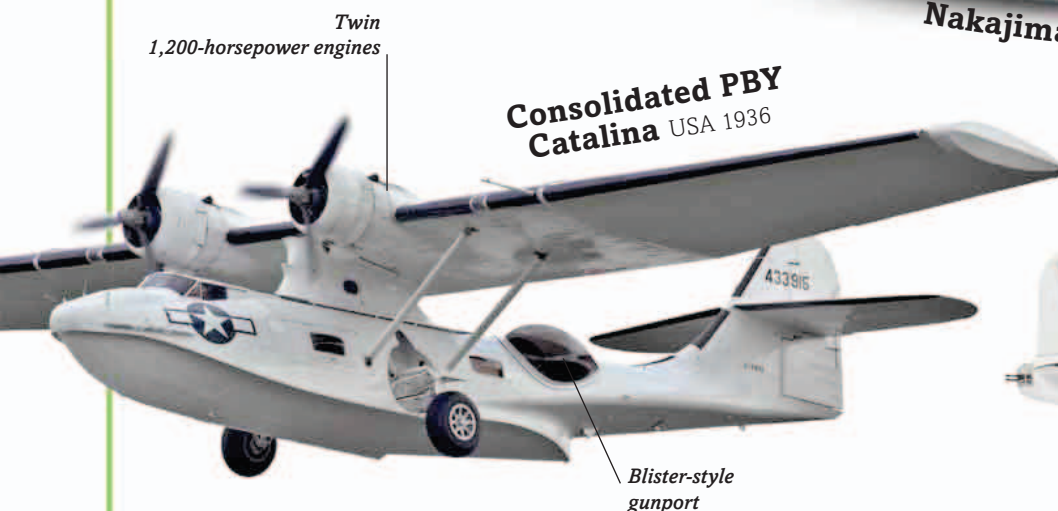
Long body holds up to 100 passengers

Dornier Do-X Germany 1929

Radial engine gives top speed of 186 mph (300 km/h) and range of 550 miles (900 km)



Nakajima Type 95 Willow Japan 1935



Twin 1,200-horsepower engines

Consolidated PBX Catalina
USA 1936

Blister-style gunport

Deep fuselage contains bunks, flushing toilet, and workshop building and repairing parts



Gun turret

Short Sunderland UK 1938

Planes that can land and take off from water are known as seaplanes. There are two types of these versatile machines—floatplanes, which sit on water using pontoons (buoyant floats), and flying boats with a watertight body, like a boat.

Floatplanes saw service in both the World Wars. The **Sopwith Baby** patrolled coasts and spotted airships in WWI. The **Nakajima Type 95 Willow** flew as a light bomber during WWII, while military flying boats, such as the **Short Sunderland** and **Consolidated PBX Catalina**,